

A Two-Isogeny Descent Attached to Campbell's Eight-Term Family

Draft

Revised 3 September 2026

Abstract

Starting from Campbell's cubic Weierstrass family with eight rational points whose x -coordinates are $0, \dots, 7$, we reconstruct the quartic condition for the ninth candidate and record every rational specialization boundary. We identify its Jacobian and rational 2-torsion, then perform an exact finite local calculation for the dual 2-isogeny descents. The resulting Selmer groups have dimensions 3 and 2, respectively, which gives Mordell–Weil rank at most 3. We also compute the full $\mathbf{Q} \times K$ representative of the binary-quartic cubic invariant and its rational 2-torsion projection. A versioned supplement records the 512 local cells, common-parameter local witnesses, exact generators, certificates, and regression tests. The same-parameter genus-5 fibre product is everywhere locally soluble. Our calculation is deliberately narrower than the original extension problem: it neither produces nor excludes a ninth rational point on Campbell's family, claims no full 2-Selmer group or Mordell–Weil rank equality, and does not evaluate a Cassels–Tate pairing. The results are therefore a reproducible finite descent computation and a rigorously delimited input to further arithmetic study of the ninth-value curve.

Keywords. elliptic curves; 2-isogeny descent; Selmer groups; arithmetic progressions; local solubility.

Mathematics Subject Classification (2020). Primary 11G05; Secondary 11G30, 11Y50.

1 The Campbell quartic

Campbell [1, Corollary 2.4 and Theorem 2.5] uses the parameter change

$$t = \frac{6m^2 - 126m - 285360}{m^2 - 72256}.$$

Its denominator never vanishes for $m \in \mathbf{Q}$, since $268^2 < 72256 < 269^2$. In the normalization used here put

$$g_m(x) = g_3x^3 + g_2x^2 + g_1x + g_0,$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} g_3 &= -18816m^4 + 677376m^3 + 1922543616m^2 - 48944480256m - 40678301368320, \\ g_2 &= 236896m^4 - 9821952m^3 - 22598349824m^2 + 508953231360m + 520252184657920, \\ g_1 &= -958800m^4 + 40985280m^3 + 89932669440m^2 - 1957723729920m - 2113363439616000, \\ g_0 &= 1292769m^4 - 57304800m^3 - 118795148928m^2 + 2647001548800m + 2758336954896384. \end{aligned}$$

Exact expansion gives $g_m(j) = q_j(m)^2$ for $0 \leq j \leq 6$; the square roots are listed in Table 1. The eighth condition is

$$\begin{aligned} Y^2 = D(m) &= -264815m^4 - 19343520m^3 + 62846856064m^2 \\ &\quad - 2906312951808m - 495507443511296, \end{aligned}$$

Table 1: The first seven prescribed square roots in Campbell's family

j	$q_j(m)$
0	$3(379m^2 - 8400m - 17506624)$
1	$743m^2 - 17136m - 33534272$
2	$415m^2 - 11088m - 16946752$
3	$3(67m^2 - 3696m - 494656)$
4	$209m^2 - 17136m + 5050432$
5	$263m^2 - 25200m + 10631872$
6	$63(m^2 - 2352m + 72256)$

because $g_m(7) = D(m)$. The candidate immediately following the eight indices $0, \dots, 7$ has index 8, and direct expansion gives $g_m(8) = H(m)$, where

$$H(m) = -850079m^4 - 11210976m^3 + 138714149248m^2 \\ - 5501355374592m - 1679721044504576$$

and put $C_H : z^2 = H(m)$. Thus Campbell's construction supplies eight prescribed squares precisely when (m, Y) lies on $Y^2 = D(m)$, and $z^2 = H(m)$ tests the ninth candidate at the same m .

There are no omitted rational specialization boundaries. The leading coefficient factors as

$$g_3 = -18816(m^2 - 72256)(m^2 - 36m - 29920),$$

and its two quadratic factors have no rational roots. After division by -65028096 , the discriminant of g_m in x is a primitive degree-16 polynomial irreducible modulo 53, hence it has no rational zero. The point $m = \infty$ is not rational on $Y^2 = D(m)$, since its leading equation would be $Y^2 = -264815M^4$. A zero of D or H merely gives $Y = 0$ or $z = 0$ at one of the distinct x -coordinates; it does not make g_m singular. Finally, D and H are separable and coprime, so their smooth fibre product has genus 5.

Lemma 1 (same-parameter local solubility). *The smooth curve*

$$Y^2 = D(m), \quad z^2 = H(m)$$

has points over $\mathbb{R}$ and every $\mathbb{Q}_p$.

Proof. The supplement stores a common m and both square roots at $\mathbb{R}$, $\mathbb{Q}_2$, every odd prime below 101, and every odd prime dividing the two quartic discriminants or their resultant. The branch-bad set is

$$\{2, 3, 5, 7, 17, 19, 31, 59, 8599, 71699, 898543, 23037169, 339106321, 1153266911\}.$$

At every remaining prime $p \geq 101$ the fibre product has smooth genus-5 reduction, and the Weil bound $\#C(\mathbb{F}_p) \geq p + 1 - 10\sqrt{p} > 0$ supplies a smooth point, which lifts by Hensel's lemma. The exact witness table is the object `same_m_local_certificates` in the manifest-bound certificate. $\square$

In particular C_H is everywhere locally soluble. Nothing here asserts that the fibre product or C_H has a rational point.

For a binary quartic

$$g(X, Z) = a_0X^4 + a_1X^3Z + a_2X^2Z^2 + a_3XZ^3 + a_4Z^4$$

we use

$$I = 12a_0a_4 - 3a_1a_3 + a_2^2, \quad J = 72a_0a_2a_4 - 27a_0a_3^2 - 27a_1^2a_4 + 9a_1a_2a_3 - 2a_2^3.$$

The resulting Jacobian is $y^2 = x^3 - 27Ix - 27J$; see [3, Lemma 2.1] for the binary-quartic description of the full 2-Selmer group.

2 The cubic algebra and the Campbell class

Let $L = \mathbf{Q}[\varphi]/(\varphi^3 - 3I\varphi + J)$. For the above normalization, the cubic invariant of g is

$$z(g) = \frac{4a_0\varphi + 3a_1^2 - 8a_0a_2}{3} \in L^\times/L^{\times 2}; \quad (1)$$

this is the invariant used in [3, Section 2]. In the present case

$$L \simeq \mathbf{Q} \times K, \quad K = \mathbf{Q}(w), \quad w^2 = D, \quad D = 1434501462453361 = 59 \cdot 71699 \cdot 339106321.$$

The quadratic resolvent factor is

$$T^2 + 269378023424T - 36009487121810563530752,$$

whose discriminant is $12288^2 D$. Thus its roots are $-134689011712 \pm 6144w$. Although $\mathcal{O}_K = \mathbb{Z}[(1+w)/2]$, all displayed coordinates below use the $\mathbf{Q}$ -basis $(1, w)$.

Proposition 2. *The two components of the cubic invariant of H are*

$$z_{\mathbf{Q}} = 9250179026780160 = 35 \cdot 16257024^2$$

and

$$z_K = 467235380575281152 - 6963847168w = 64^2(114071137835762 - 1700158w).$$

Moreover

$$N_{K/\mathbf{Q}}(114071137835762 - 1700158w) = 35 \cdot 15915620907648^2,$$

and the full norm is

$$z_{\mathbf{Q}} N_{K/\mathbf{Q}}(z_K) = 37093056870271943410974720^2.$$

Proof. Insert the five coefficients of H into (1), then evaluate in the rational and quadratic factors of L . Squaring the three displayed integers gives the claimed identities. These are integer identities, independently recomputed by the accompanying regression test. $\square$

The rational factor in $L = \mathbf{Q} \times K$ is the cohomological factor induced by the rational 2-torsion point. On scaling

$$x_{\text{big}} = 64^2 x, \quad y_{\text{big}} = 64^3 y$$

and translating $X = x + 197298357$, the Jacobian becomes

$$E : y^2 = X^3 - 591895071X^2 + 58536289153843200X. \quad (2)$$

Since $-3\varphi_0 = 64^2(-197298357)$ for the rational resolvent root $\varphi_0 = 269378023424$, the rational projection of $[H] \in H^1(\mathbf{Q}, E[2])$ is the X -Kummer squareclass [35]. This assertion concerns one projection only: C_H is not thereby identified with the even quartic C_{35} below.

3 The rational two-isogeny

Write $A = -591895071$ and $B = 58536289153843200$. The quotient by $(0, 0)$ gives

$$\phi : E \longrightarrow E', \quad E' : y^2 = X^3 - 2AX^2 + (A^2 - 4B)X,$$

so explicitly

$$E' : y^2 = X^3 + 1183790142X^2 + 116194618458722241X. \quad (3)$$

We denote the dual isogeny by $\hat{\phi} : E' \rightarrow E$. The standard isogeny descent and its covering quartics are described, for example, in [5, Chapter X, Section 4] and [2, Chapter 14]; higher descent with rational 2-torsion is treated directly in [4].

Lemma 3 (support). *For $E_{a,b} : y^2 = x^3 + ax^2 + bx$, every class in the x -Kummer isogeny Selmer group has a squarefree representative supported on -1 and the prime divisors of b . The class d is represented by*

$$C_d : \quad N^2 = dU^4 + aU^2V^2 + (b/d)V^4. \quad (4)$$

Proof. Let $p \nmid b$ divide a squarefree representative d , and after weighted projective scaling take $U, V \in \mathbb{Z}_p$ primitive. In the original equation (4), if V were a unit, then $(b/d)V^4$ would be the unique term of valuation -1 on the right, which cannot be the valuation of the square N^2 . Hence $p \mid V$, so primitivity makes U a unit. The right side of (4) then has valuation exactly 1, again impossible for a square. Notice that this argument does not assume in advance that N is p -integral. Thus $v_p(d)$ is even outside b , and squareclass reduction gives the stated support. $\square$

Lemma 4 (good primes). *Fix a supported squarefree d . If a finite prime p does not divide $2b(a^2 - 4b)$, then the smooth projective model of C_d has a $\mathbf{Q}_p$ -point.*

Proof. The binary-quartic discriminant of the right side of (4) is

$$16b(a^2 - 4b)^2.$$

Thus C_d has smooth geometrically connected genus-one reduction at p . In this application such a p is at least 5, so the Hasse bound gives $\#C_d(\mathbf{F}_p) \geq p + 1 - 2\sqrt{p} > 0$. Every point of the smooth reduction lifts by Hensel's lemma. $\square$

4 Exact local classification

The only places required on either side are

$$S = \{\infty, 2, 3, 5, 7, 59, 71699, 339106321\}.$$

Lemma 3 gives 32 signed candidates on each side, and Lemma 4 proves that no unlisted place can remove one. The certificate contains all $64 \times 8 = 512$ local cells. A YES cell contains an exact squareclass witness; a NO cell is either an exhaustive weighted-projective computation modulo the displayed prime power or the valuation-normalized double-root obstruction. All 56 cells that had previously been unresolved are now split into 24 YES cells at 3 and 32 NO cells at 59 or 71699.

Table 2: Exact local classification of the two isogeny-descent candidate sets

side	candidates	first real NO	first finite NO	survivors	survivor set
E	32	16	8 at 59	8	1, 3, 5, 7, 15, 21, 35, 105
E'	32	0	24 at 2, 4 at 3	4	1, 4230241, 339106321, D

The complete matrix has 384 YES and 128 NO cells. Its JSON SHA-256 is

fff2f35f398c2d14227d9b032d205e24d5332a39346487c76180cdf805ba32c9.

The structured $\mathbf{Q} \times K$ and Selmer certificate has SHA-256

7fbd4d00435d2f3ef7bd74b0f87822b8e6fb3b893e2023ce9b5741c411538e18.

This is the clean Round-04 certificate: it contains only the exact Selmer, $\mathbf{Q} \times K$, scaling, and proved Mordell–Weil-image data. The superseded opposite-side pairing proposal is absent; its failure is recorded only in the separate Round-05 negative audit. Both files, the same- m certificate, their generators and regression tests are located by supplement release

with root manifest

PAPER_ELLIPTIC_SUPPLEMENT_MANIFEST.json.

The manifest SHA-256 is

583ec02b13c96824df5563d0dc7cc0312b7fbb33e5b7860b4f692b1fbed228fd.

The manifest records byte lengths, roles, evidence eligibility, Python and SymPy versions, and exact reproduction commands. Its archive URL is null; this is a local release candidate rather than a public archive.

Theorem 5. *With E -side classes represented by the X -Kummer map on E and E' -side classes by that on E' , one has*

$$\mathrm{Sel}^{\widehat{\phi}}(E'/\mathbf{Q}) = \langle 3, 5, 7 \rangle, \quad \mathrm{Sel}^{\phi}(E/\mathbf{Q}) = \langle 4230241, 339106321 \rangle.$$

Their $\mathbf{F}_2$ -dimensions are respectively 3 and 2.

Proof. The two support lists are exhaustive by Lemma 3; all good places are automatic by Lemma 4. The certificate checks the remaining finite and real places and yields exactly the survivor sets in Table 2. Direct squareclass multiplication verifies that the two sets are the groups generated as displayed. $\square$

The exact sequence underlying descent by a degree-2 isogeny gives

$$2^{\mathrm{rank} E(\mathbf{Q})} = \frac{|E'(\mathbf{Q})/\phi E(\mathbf{Q})| |E(\mathbf{Q})/\widehat{\phi} E'(\mathbf{Q})|}{|E(\mathbf{Q})[\phi]| |E'(\mathbf{Q})[\widehat{\phi}]|},$$

see [6, pp. 368–369]. Both denominator groups here have order 2, and the two Mordell–Weil quotients inject into the two Selmer groups.

Corollary 6. $\mathrm{rank} E(\mathbf{Q}) \leq 3$.

5 Correction of the proposed pairing gate

For clarity we record the relevant cohomological direction. The standard pairing that upgrades a descent by $\widehat{\phi}$ to a full 2-descent is an alternating pairing

$$\mathrm{Sel}^{\widehat{\phi}}(E'/\mathbf{Q}) \times \mathrm{Sel}^{\widehat{\phi}}(E'/\mathbf{Q}) \longrightarrow \mathbf{Q}/\mathbb{Z}, \tag{5}$$

whose radical is the image of the appropriate full 2-Selmer group; see [6, Equation (2)]. In particular, it is a pairing on one isogeny Selmer group squared, not a pairing between the two groups in Theorem 5. The full Cassels–Tate pairing on binary quartics likewise has domain $\mathrm{Sel}^{(2)}(E/\mathbf{Q}) \times \mathrm{Sel}^{(2)}(E/\mathbf{Q})$ [3, Theorem 3.1].

Proposition 7 (pairing correction). *The expression formerly denoted $\langle 35, 4230241 \rangle_{CT}$ in this project is not defined by either of the standard pairings just cited: 35 and 4230241 are coordinates in opposite isogeny Selmer groups. Consequently its proposed tangent-line formula cannot be used to deduce $C_H(\mathbf{Q}) = \emptyset$.*

Proof. The domain mismatch follows directly from (5) and Theorem 5. There is a second consistency check. By Lemma 1, C_H is everywhere locally soluble, so it represents a class of $\mathrm{Sel}^{(2)}(E/\mathbf{Q})$, and its projection is 35. Hence 35 already lies in the image whose radical is tested by (5); any correctly defined same-side lifting pairing must annihilate it. $\square$

The arithmetic that exposed the problem is still useful as a negative certificate. For the standard even quartic

$$N^2 = 35U^4 - 591895071U^2V^2 + 1672465404395520V^4$$

the associated conic in $R = U^2, S = V^2$ has the rational point

$$(R_0, S_0, N_0) = (16257024, 1, 36058176).$$

A primitive tangent there is

$$L_{35} = 60677401R - 697502396215296S - 8012928N.$$

Both identities follow by direct substitution. If one nevertheless evaluates the rejected expression $(L_{35}(P_v), 4230241)_v$, then the two Hensel branches give the exact residues in Table 3.

Table 3: Branch dependence of the rejected local Hilbert-symbol expression						
p	modulus	N		L_{35}	$v_p(L_{35})$	Hilbert symbol
59	59^3	56226		127303	0	−1
59	59^3	149153		145730	1	+1
71699	71699^3	152989401412805	252464922339130		0	−1
71699	71699^3	215596989132294	195462237955773		1	+1

Each listed N squares to the quartic right side modulo the listed modulus. Thus independent local branch choices yield both possible products. This does not compute a Cassels–Tate value; it proves that the formerly proposed bare expression lacks the cochain or denominator data needed for well-definedness.

6 The exact remaining full-descent problem

To test the Campbell class itself one must now do one of the following equivalent full-descent computations.

1. Compute a basis of $\text{Sel}^{(2)}(E/\mathbf{Q})$ as everywhere locally soluble binary quartics g_i with the same I, J ; identify $[H]$ by the full $z(H) \in (\mathbf{Q} \times K)^\times / (\mathbf{Q} \times K)^{\times 2}$; and compute $\langle [H], [g_i] \rangle_{CT}$ by the full binary-quartic formula of [3, Theorem 3.1].
2. Compute the locally soluble 4-coverings lying above C_H . An empty output proves that its 2-Selmer class does not lift and hence that $C_H(\mathbf{Q}) = \emptyset$; a nonempty output does not by itself produce a rational point. This is the precise role of a four-descent [7, Section “Four-Descent”].

The accompanying Magma input freezes both routes, but the manifest marks it `UNEXECUTED_FROZEN_CANDIDATE_INPUT` and `mathematical_evidence_eligible=false`. No transcript or trusted binary hash is present. Therefore no full 2-Selmer dimension, Cassels–Tate value, Mordell–Weil rank equality, or rational-point conclusion is claimed.

7 Finite theorem and reproducibility boundary

Theorem 8 (finite Campbell–Jacobian calculation). *For the binary quartic H obtained at index 8 from Campbell’s Theorem 2.5, the two isogeny Selmer groups are those in Theorem 5; hence $\text{rank } E(\mathbf{Q}) \leq 3$. Its cubic-algebra invariant is the pair of Proposition 2, with rational 2-torsion projection [35]. Moreover the same-parameter genus-5 fibre product is everywhere locally soluble.*

This is a finite, certificate-backed theorem. Exact-coefficient searches did not locate a published computation of these particular Selmer groups; that is a not-found report, not proof of novelty or priority. The theorem neither asserts the existence or nonexistence of a rational ninth point nor computes the full 2-Selmer group or any Cassels–Tate value.

Statements and Declarations

Funding. *Placeholder: the human authors must insert the verified funding statement.*

Competing interests. *Placeholder: the human authors must insert the verified financial and non-financial interests statement.*

Author contributions. *Placeholder: the human authors must insert the approved contribution statement.*

Ethics approval, consent to participate, and consent for publication. Not applicable: this article contains only mathematical research and uses no human participants, personal data, or animals.

Data and code availability. The exact generators, JSON certificates, and regression tests are identified by supplement release `paper-elliptic-campbell-supplement-v0.6.1`. They are currently sealed only in the local deterministic archive candidate; before submission the authors must deposit those exact bytes and provide a verified persistent DOI or URL: <<PERSISTENT DOI/URL REQUIRED>>.

Use of generative AI and AI-assisted technologies. AI-assisted tools were used during exploratory symbolic-algebra scripting, test drafting, literature-query formulation, and prose preparation. No AI system is an author. Before submission, the named human authors must independently verify and accept every mathematical claim, reference, source file, code artifact, and disclosure, and they remain accountable for the final work.

Supplementary information. Online Resource 1: deterministic verification archive containing the exact source, frozen reference PDF, generators, certificates, data dictionary, and regression tests identified by release root `paper-elliptic-campbell-local-release-v0.6.3`. The unexecuted Magma input is included solely as an ineligible candidate input and is not evidence for any theorem. The journal name, author names, affiliations, corresponding author email, and public archive identifier remain human-supplied metadata.

References

- [1] G. Campbell, “A note on arithmetic progressions on elliptic curves,” *Journal of Integer Sequences* **6** (2003), Article 03.1.3, <https://cs.uwaterloo.ca/journals/JIS/VOL6/Campbell/campbell14.html>.
- [2] J. W. S. Cassels, *Lectures on Elliptic Curves*, LMS Student Texts 24, Cambridge University Press, 1991.
- [3] T. Fisher, “On binary quartics and the Cassels–Tate pairing,” *Research in Number Theory* **8** (2022), article 74, <https://doi.org/10.1007/s40993-022-00376-z>.
- [4] T. Fisher, “Higher descents on an elliptic curve with a rational 2-torsion point,” *Mathematics of Computation* **86** (2017), 2493–2518, <https://doi.org/10.1090/mcom/3163>.

- [5] J. H. Silverman, *The Arithmetic of Elliptic Curves*, second edition, Graduate Texts in Mathematics 106, Springer, 2009.
- [6] M. van Beek and T. Fisher, “Computing the Cassels–Tate pairing on 3-isogeny Selmer groups via cubic norm equations,” *Acta Arithmetica* **185** (2018), 367–396, <https://doi.org/10.4064/aa171108-11-4>.
- [7] W. Bosma, J. Cannon, and C. Playoust, “The Magma algebra system. I. The user language,” *J. Symbolic Comput.* **24** (1997), 235–265; current descent interface documented at <https://magma.maths.usyd.edu.au/magma/handbook/text/1570>.